H-B-00515a (GSA-FSS)
September 27, 1966
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. H-B-00515 (GSA-FSS)
May 4, 1964

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BRUSH, SCRUB, BASEBOARD

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Standardization Division, Washington, D.C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It has been partially coordinated with industry but has not been coordinated with Government agencies and is subject to modification. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION.

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for scrub brushes primarily intended for use in scrubbing baseboards, corners and floor area adjacent to baseboards.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types and classes. Scrub brushes covered by this specification shall be of the following types and classes, as specified in the contract or order (see 6.1):

Type I - With handle
  Class 1 - Vegetable fiber
  Class 2 - Synthetic filament (crimped)

Type II - Without handle
  Class 1 - Vegetable fiber
  Class 2 - Synthetic filament (crimped)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

H-S-951 - Synthetic Filament, General Specifications for Brushes
NN-H-104 - Handles, Wood, Acme Threaded and Circular Tapered End
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Metal Stayed
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

FSC 7920

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of
MIL-W-6110 - Wood, Determination of Moisture Content of

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Preproduction sample approval. When specified (see 6.1) before production is commenced, a sample of the item shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for examination and approval in accordance with 4.2. Approval of the preproduction sample authorizes commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with the detailed provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacturer of the production item.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Vegetable fiber, Class 1. The fiber for Class 1 brushes shall be 100 percent oiled palmetto.

3.2.2 Synthetic filament, Class 2. The synthetic filament for Class 2 brushes shall be of organic material made by the copolymerization of styrene with acrylonitrile resin or a comparable unsaturated compound. The filament shall be dyed black and shall meet the requirements of Class "S" filament in Specification H-S-951 except that the filaments shall be crimped with an average of 7.5 to 8.5 crimps per inch. The filament shall be .023 inch plus or minus .001 inch in diameter.

3.2.3 Block (wood). Wood shall be a close-grained and straight grained hardwood, thoroughly and uniformly dried to a moisture content of not less than 8 and not more than 12 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.4 (see 4.3.2.1).

3.2.4 Handle (wood). Wood for the handle of type I brush shall be the same as specified for the type I, acme threaded handle in NN-H-104.

3.2.5 Staples. The staples shall be commercial steel wire, plated, or coated to resist corrosion, or a commercial grade of corrosion-resisting steel wire. The diameter shall be not less than 0.039 inch for class 1 brushes and shall be not less than 0.0325 inch for class 2 brushes.

3.3. Construction.

3.3.1 Block. The wood block shall be triangular shape; chamfered corner and side edges, beveled ends; coated with transparent varnish, clear lacquer or other suitable transparent organic coating; and shall have two symmetrical holes for the handle, one on each side equidistant from the end of the block. The holes shall be threaded to receive the acme threaded handle (3.3.2) at an angle of 45 degrees plus or minus 10 degrees from horizontal. The holes for tufts shall be so placed so that the tufts form a 90 degree angle at the apex of the block. The exposed end of the fiber bristles for Class 1 brushes shall be trimmed to taper from 2-1/4 inches at apex of block down to 1-1/2 inches at corner of block. The exposed ends of the filaments for Class 2 brushes shall be trimmed to taper from 2 inches at apex of block down to 1-1/2 inches at corner of block. The first row of holes across the ends and sides of the block shall be placed 1/4 inch in from the edges of the block.

3.3.2 Handle. When type I brushes are specified (see 6.1), the handle shall meet the requirements specified in NN-H-104 for the type 1, size 2 (15/16 in. dia.) acme threaded end handle. The length over-all shall be 54 inches (4-1/2 ft.) or 60 inches (5 ft.) in accordance with the manufacturer's standard commercial practice, unless otherwise specified (see 6.1).

3.3.3 Fibers and filaments. The fiber or filaments shall solidly fill the tuft holes in the block and shall be securely staple set with wire staples (3.2.5). The staples shall stradle over the middle of the tuft and shall be driven into the block at the bottom of the holes so the tufts shall not separate from the block when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4 Physical requirements. The brush shall conform to the physical requirements in table I.

3.5 Marking for identification. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), in addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, the brush manufacturer shall permanently and legibly place his name, or trademark, in accordance with commercial practice, easily identifiable with said manufacture, on each brush block.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be in accordance with the best commercial practice. The brush block assemblies shall be free from defects which affect their appearance or which affect their serviceability. Handles when furnished shall be of the quality required by NN-H-104.

TABLE I. Physical Requirements

Brushes	Class 1	Class 2
Block:		
Length over-all, minimum inches	5-1/2	5-1/2
Width over-all, minimum inches	2-3/4	2-7/8
Holes for fiber or filament:		
Number of holes, minimum.	92	100
Number of rows, minimum.	16	16
Number of holes across each row, minimum except where necessary to form the apex.	6	6
Depth of holes, approximate inch	5/16	1/2
Dia. of holes, approximate inch	1/4	3/8
Fiber or filament:		
Length clear of block, minimum inches	1-1/2	1-1/2
Number of fibers or filaments per tuft, minimum	60	38
Weight of fibers or filaments per brush, minimum ounces	3-1/4	4

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection. When a preproduction sample is required, it shall be examined for the defects in table II and specified dimensions. The preproduction sample shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1, 4.4.2 and 4.4.3.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.2 In process inspection.

4.3.2.1 Moisture content of brush block wood. The brush block wood shall be tested for moisture content as specified in 4.4.4 to determine compliance with 3.2.3, The sample unit shall be one block. The lot shall be the number of blocks being manufactured under essentially the same conditions and being offered for inspection at one time. The test shall be conducted immediately prior to machining (forming, chamfering, drilling, etc.) the blocks. The requirements shall be applicable to the lot average and the results reported numerically to the nearest 0.1 percent. There shall be one determination made per block. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3.3 End item inspection. The lot shall consist of all brushes including the handles, when specified, offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated brush and handle, when specified.

4.3.3.1 Visual examination. Examination shall be made of the end item for the defects in table II. The inspection level shall be level II with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Visual defects.

Examine	Defects
Finish	Block and handle (if applicable) not smoothly finished and coated with varnish, lacquer, or other suitable clear organic coating.
	Coating not uniform or continuous; wet or tacky; dirt or foreign matter embedded.
Construction and Workmanship	Not type brush specified. Block not close-grained and straight-grained hardwood; any knot hole or loose knot; any tight or firmly encased knot 3/16 inch or more in diameter; any season check, fracture, or split; any wormhole, larva channel or pocket; any wane (lack of wood); loose, raised or torn grain producing a rough surface. Threads not continuous, not firm or free of imperfections. Handle will not fit threaded holes in block properly. Handle not free of defects specified in MN-H-104. Fiber or filament (bristles) embedded with foreign matter, dirty, or not properly trimmed.
Marking for identification	Omitted, illegible. Special markings not provided when specified.

4.3.3.2 Dimensional examination. Inspection shall be made of the end item for compliance with table I. Any deviation from specified requirements shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in the terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.3.3 Testing of the end item. The end item shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1, 4.4.2, and 4.4.3. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in the terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.4 Inspection of preparation of delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table III. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation of delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size; location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping; or distortion of container.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4 Tests

4.4.1 Retention of fiber or filament tuft. Grasp the individual tuft of fibers or filaments (bristles) with a suitable holding device and apply a pulling force, with a spring scale or a weight, of eight pounds in a direction tending to pull the tuft from the block to determine compliance with 3.3.3. Ten determinations shall be made per brush. Failure of one or more determinations shall constitute a defect.

4.4.2 Weight of fiber and filament. The fiber or filament shall be removed from the block and shall be conditioned for not less than 16 hours in air at a relative humidity of 50 plus or minus 4 percent and at a temperature of 23° plus or minus 1.1° C (73.5° ± 2° F). The weight of the fiber or filament shall be determined in the same atmosphere to determine compliance with table I.

4.4.3 Synthetic filament (class 2). The synthetic filaments shall be tested for the requirements specified in 4.4.3.1 and 4.4.3.2. The filament removed from the sample brushes to determine the weight (4.4.2) shall be used for these test.

4.4.3.1 Filament diameter, crimp, and crimp amplitude. To determine compliance with 3.2.2 the diameter, crimp, and crimp amplitude shall be measured as described in H-S-951.

4.4.3.2 Synthetic filament test. The filament from the sample brushes (see 4.4.2) shall be tested for specific gravity, solvent resistance, softening point and shrinkage as described in H-S-951.

4.4.4 Test for moisture content of wood (block). Wood for the block shall be tested for moisture content in accordance with any method specified in MIL-W-6110 to determine compliance with 3.2.3.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I or II, brush. Each brush shall be packaged in accordance with method IC-2 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.2 Level B.

5.1.2.1 Type I or II, brush. Each brush shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.3 Level C. The brushes shall be packaged to afford protection against corrosion, deterioration and damage from the supplier to the initial destination..

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Type I or II, brushes. Type I or II brushes furnished in quantities as specified (see 6.1) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitation of the box specification.

5.2.1.2 Type I, handles. Type I handles furnished in quantities as specified (see 6.1) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. The gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. When specified (see 6.1) the handles shall be bundled and secured with filament reinforced tape, steel strapping or round wire. The bundle shall be wrapped with burlap and shall be secured by sewing ends and side seams with yarn or twine.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Type I or II, brushes. Twelve type I or II unit packages of brushes shall be packed in a close fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.2.2 Type I, handles. Twelve type I handles shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. When specified (see 6.1) twelve handles shall be bundled and secured with filament reinforced tape, steel strapping or round wire. The bundle shall be wrapped with burlap and shall be secured by sewing ends and side seams with yarn or twine.

5.2.3 Level C. The brushes or handles shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packaging and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packaging and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should excercise any desired option offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type of brush required (see 1.2.1).
(c) Class of brush required (see 1.2.1).
(d) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.1).
(e) Length handle required (see 3.3.2).
(f) Special markings required (see 3.5).
(g) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(h) Quantity of unit packages of brushes required in shipping container (see 5.2.2.1).
(i) Quantity of handles required in shipping container or in bundle (see 5.2.2.2).
(j) Whether handles shall be bundled (see 5.2.1.2 and 5.2.2.2).

GSA DC 67-9674

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:06Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.